

Module 3 Practice Tasks Playbook

3-1 CSS Basics - Inline, Internal, External Styles

CSS is the make-up and clothing of a website - same HTML, totally different look. There are three ways to attach it: inline (style attribute on one element), internal (a `<style>` block in `<head>`), and external (a separate.css file linked with `<link>`). External wins for any real project because one file can style hundreds of pages.

Practice Tasks

1. Create a folder "css-learning" with index.html and style.css, and connect them with `<link rel="stylesheet">`.
2. Take one `<h1>Hello</h1>` and change its color three different ways external used. inline, internal, one at a time. Add a one-line comment above each saying which method you are using.
3. Style body background-color, an h1's color/text-align, and a box class's padding/border/border-radius in your external file.
4. In your own words (1-2 lines, no AI yet), write down why professionals almost always choose External CSS.

3-2 CSS Selectors - Tag, Class, ID, Universal, Combined

A selector is just an address for "who gets this style."

- Universal (*) reaches everyone.
- Tag reaches every element of one kind.
- Class reaches a reusable group.
- ID reaches exactly one element.

Combined selectors (space, `>`, `+`, `~`) target elements based on their relationship to each other.

Practice Tasks

1. Add 3+ `<p>` tags to a page and style all of them at once with a single tag selector.
2. Create two classes (e.g..highlight, .error) and apply both to the same element together confirm both styles show up.
3. Give exactly one element a unique id and style it separately from every other element on the page.
4. Write a basic CSS reset using `{ margin: 0; padding: 0; box-sizing: border-box; }` and explain in a comment why this is done.
5. Build a nested structure: a `<div>` containing a `<p>`, plus a second `<p>` outside it as a sibling. Write one selector using `>` that targets only the direct child, and one using `~` that targets the sibling. Note what changes and what doesn't.

3-3 CSS Styling - Font, Background

Font properties (family/size/weight/line-height) control how text reads.

Background properties (color/image/size/position/gradient) control the backdrop.

Position (static/relative/absolute/fixed/sticky) controls where an element physically sits and

the rule to remember: a child with position:absolute needs a parent with position:relative, or it escapes to the whole page.

Practice Tasks

1. Style one paragraph with a font-family stack that ends in a generic family (sans-serif/serif), then tune font-size, font-weight and line-height until it's comfortable to read.
2. Give a card a linear-gradient 0 background. Separately, compare background-size: cover vs contain on the same image and describe the difference.

3-4 CSS Display, Visibility & Box-Shadow

Display decides how an element occupies space: block (own line, full width), inline (shares a line, no width/height control), inline-block (best of both), none (gone entirely, no space kept).

Visibility: hidden hides an element but keeps its space. box-shadow adds fake depth using offset, blur, spread and color.

Practice Tasks

1. Place 3 boxes and switch each one between block, inline, and inline-block. Note which ones actually respect width/height.
2. Take one box and toggle it between display: none and visibility: hidden. In your own words, describe exactly what's different about the layout in each case.
3. Build one hoverable card: a normal box-shadow at rest, and on :hover, a bigger/colored shadow combined with transform: translateY(-4px) so it looks like it lifts off the page.